MIL-B-43861A
9 July 1986
SUPERSEDING
MIL-B-43861
29 November 1973

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

BAG, PLASTIC, MORTUARY

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This document covers one type of ethylene vinyl acetate bag (see 6.1).

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

* 2.1 Government documents. Unless otherwise specified, the following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this document to the extent specified herein.

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

A-A-203	-	Paper, Kraft, Untreated.
PPP-B-636	-	Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard.
PPP-T-45	-	Tape, Gummed, Paper, Reinforced and Plain, For Sealing and Securing.
PPP-T-97	-	Tape, Pressure-Sensitive Adhesive, Filament Reinforced.

MILITARY

MIL-B-371	-	Braid, Textile, Tubular.
MIL-L-35078	-	Loads, Unit: Preparation of Semiperishable Subsistance Items; Clothing, Personal Equipment and Equipage; General Specification For

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: U.S. Army Natick Research, Development, and Engineering Center, Natick, MA 01760-5014 by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

AMSC N/A FSC 9930

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STANDARDS

FEDERAL

FED-STD-595 - Colors.

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.
MIL-STD-147 - Palletized Unit Loads.

DRAWING

U.S. ARMY NATICK RESEARCH, DEVELOPMENT, AND ENGINEERING CENTER

8-2-498 - Bag, Plastic, Mortuary

(Copies of documents required by contractors in connection with specific acquisition functions should be obtained from the contracting activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

* 2.2 Other publications. Unless otherwise specified, the following documents of the issue in effect on the date of invitation for bids or reques' for proposal, form a part of this document to the extent specified herein.

AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR TESTING AND MATERIALS (ASTM)

D 882 - Tensile Properties of Thin Plastic Sheeting

D 1505 - Density of Plastics By The Density-Gradient Technique

D 3951 - Standard Practice for Commercial Packaging

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.)

(Technical society and technical association documents are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.)

* 2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this document and the references cited herein (except for associated detail specifications, specification sheets or MS standards), the text of this document shall take precedence. Nothing in this document however, shall supersede applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

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3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Materials.

3.1.1 Plastic tubing. The body of the bag shall be an extruded tubing of ethylene-vinyl acetate copolymer, 4.5 ± 0.5 percent vinyl acetate content, and shall contain no plasticizers. The color of the film shall approximate color No. 24087 of FED-STD-595. The extruded film shall meet the requirements of table I when tested as specified in 4.2.4.

TABLE I. Physical requirements of the plastic tubing

Thickness, inches	0.006 ± 0.001
Density, g/cm^3	0.920 min., 0.930 max.
Breaking strength, lbs., min.:	
Machine direction	12
Transverse direction	9.5
Elongation, percent, min.:	
Machine direction	350
Transverse direction	350
Tear strength, grams, min.:	
Machine direction	1000
Transverse direction	500

3.1.2 Tape. The pressure sensitive tape used to adhere the tie cord to the bag shall conform to type II, class A or B of PPP-T-97.

3.1.3 Tie cord. The tie cord shall conform to type IV, class 3 of MIL-B-371, Olive Green 107.

3.2 Design, dimensions, and construction. The design, dimensions, and construction shall be in accordance with Drawing 8-2-498.

3.3 Performance.

3.3.1 Seam strength. The breaking strength of the bottom sealed seam and of the folds at the sides of the lay flat tube shall be not less than 6.0 pounds per inch of width when tested as specified in 4.2.4.

* 3.4 Instruction sheet. Each bag shall have an instruction sheet printed on white bond paper, 8 by 10-1/2 inches. The printing shall be standard typewriter size with the following information and format:

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"INSTRUCTIONS FOR USE

Bag, Plastic, Mortuary

1. Hold one side of the open end of the bag and whip through air to open.

2. Roll the open end back on itself until the length of the bag is approximately 3 feet.

3. Select an area free from stones and other sharp objects and lay the rolled bag down with the tie cord toward the ground.

4. Place the casualty into the bag as follows:

   a. Insert the feet so that they touch the bottom seam of the bag.
   b. Raise the legs and unroll the bag to the buttocks.
   c. Lift the casualty by the belt or waistband of the trousers and unroll the bag over the lower torso.
   d. Raise the upper torso and unroll the bag over the rest of the casualty.

5. Gather the sides at the open end of the bag and wrap the tie cord around once. Tie tightly with a single overhand knot.

6. Fold 10 inches of the gathered bag above the knot back on itself and over the first knot so the gathered end of the bag extends about 3 inche below the first knot. Wrap the tie cord completely around the gathered portion once and tie tightly with a square knot.

7. Place the bag containing the casualty into the cloth pouch and close the slide fastener. Caution: To avoid ripping the plastic, lift the casualty - DO NOT GRASP THE UNSUPPORTED BAG."

* 3.5 Workmanship. The finished bag shall be free of pimples, blisters, bubbles, pits, fish eyes, thin spots, wrinkles, resin streaks, gels exceeding 1/32 inch in diameter, and unfused resin particles exceeding 1/32 inch in diameter. Seal shall be continuous and shall be free of scorched or burned heat seals. The bag shall be free of tears, cuts, holes, cracks, breaks, deep gouges, scratches, scuffs, creases, and repair patches. The bag shall be free of dirt, oil, grit, and other foreign matter. The bag shall conform to the quality of product established by this document. The occurrence of defects shall not exceed the applicable acceptable quality levels.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

* 4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or

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any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the document where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

* 4.1.1 Responsibility for compliance. All items must meet all requirements of sections 3 and 5. The inspection set forth in this document shall become a part of the contractor's overall inspection system or quality program. The absence of any inspection requirements in the document shall not relieve the contractor of the responsibility of assuring that all products or supplies submitted to the Government for acceptance comply with all requirements of the contract. Sampling in quality conformance does not authorize submission of known defective material, either indicated or actual, nor does it commit the Government to acceptance of defective material.

* 4.1.2 Responsibility for dimensional requirements. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for assuring that all specified dimensions have been met. When dimensions cannot be examined on the end item, inspection shall be made at any point, or at all points in the manufacturing process necessary to assure compliance with all dimensional requirements.

4.1.1 Certificates of compliance. Where certificates of compliance are submitted, the Government reserves the right to inspect such items to determine the validity of the certification.

* 4.2 Quality conformance inspection. Unless otherwise specified, sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

4.2.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1, components and materials shall be inspected in accordance with all the requirements of referenced documents unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this document or applicable purchase document.

* 4.2.2 End item visual examination. The end items shall be examined for defects listed below. The lot size shall be expressed in units of bags. The sample unit shall be one bag. The inspection level shall be I and the acceptable quality level (AQL), expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 4.0.

Examine	Defect
Design and construction	Not in accordance with Drawing 8-2-498.
Material	Not extruded tubing. Any pimple, blister, bubble, pit, fish eye, thin spot, wrinkle, or resin streak.

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Examine	Defect
Material (cont'd)	Any gel defect or unfused resin particle. (Sporadic gel defects or unfused resin particles no larger than 1/32 inch in diameter will be acceptable unless occurring in seam). Not color specified.
Workmanship	Seal not continuous. Poor heat seal resulting in inadequate fusion. Any scorching or burning in area of heat seal. Tear, cut, hole, crack, break, deep gouge, scratch, scuff, crease, or repair patch. Not clean; evidence of dirt, grit, oil, or other foreign matter.
Instruction sheet	Missing or illegible. Not as specified.

* 4.2.3 End item dimensional examination. The end items shall be examined for conformance to the dimensions specified on Drawing 8-2-498. Any measurement deviating from the specified dimension shall be classified a defect. The lot size shall be expressed in units of bags. The sample unit shall be one bag. The inspection level shall be S-3 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 4.0.

4.2.4 End item testing. The end items shall be tested for the characteristics listed in table II. The lot size shall be expressed in units of bags. The sample unit shall be one bag. The inspection level shall be S-2. The lot shall be unacceptable if any sample unit fails to meet any of the requirements specified in table I.

TABLE II. End item tests

Characteristic	Requirement paragraph	Test method	No. of determinations per sample unit	Results reported to nearest
Vinyl acetate content	3.1.1	1/	-	-
Thickness	Table I	4.3.1	5	0.0001 inch
Density	Table I	ASTM D 1505	1	0.001 g/cm^3
Breaking strength: Machine direction	Table I	ASTM D 882	1	0.1 lb.

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TABLE II. End item tests (cont'd)

Characteristic	Requirement paragraph	Test method	No. of determinations per sample unit	Results reported to nearest
Transverse direction	Table I	ASTM D 882	1	0.1 lb.
Elongation:				
Machine direction	Table I	ASTM D 882	1	10 percent
Transverse direction	Table I	ASTM D 882	1	
Tear strength:				
Machine direction	Table I	ASTM D 1922	1	10 grams
Transverse direction	Table I	ASTM D 1922	1	
Seam strength	3.3.1	4.3.2	5	0.1 lb.
Tubing side strength	3.3.1	4.3.2	5	0.1 lb.

1/ Unless otherwise specified, a certificate of compliance will be accepted as evidence of compliance with the requirement.

* 4.2.5 Packaging examination. The fully packaged end items shall be examined for the defects listed below. The lot size shall be expressed in units of shipping containers. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully packaged. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 2.5.

Examine	Defect
Marking(exterior)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; of improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Materials	Any component missing, damaged, or not as specified.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components, such as incomplete closure of container flaps, loose strapping, improper taping, or inadequate stapling or reinforcing. Bulged or distorted container.

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Examine	Defect
Content	Number of mortuary bags per unit pack or shipping container is more or less than required.

* 4.2.6 Palletization examination. The fully packaged and palletized end items shall be examined for the defects listed below. The lot size shall be expressed in units of palletized unit loads. The sample unit shall be one palletized unit load, fully packaged. The inspection level shall be S-1, and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 6.5.

Examine	Defect
Finished dimensions	Length, width, or height exceeds specified maximum requirement.
Palletization	Pallet pattern not as specified. Interlocking of loads not as specified. Load not bonded with required straps as specified.
Weight	Exceeds maximum load limits.
Marking	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; of improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.

4.3 Methods of inspection.

* 4.3.1 Thickness test. The gage used for the measurement of thickness shall be a dead-weight type equipped with a dial graduated to read directly to 0.0001 inch. The presser foot shall be circular with a diameter of 0.25 ± 0.01 inch. The presser foot and moving parts connected therewith shall be weighted so as to apply a total load of 3 ± 0.1 ounce to the specimen. The presser foot and anvil surface shall be plain to within 0.0001 inch and parallel to each other within 0.0001 inch. The tubing shall be cut open and thickness measurement made on a single thickness. Five measurements shall be taken across the full width of the cut tubing. No individual measurement shall be less than the specified minimum thickness and the average of all measurements on the sample unit shall be not greater than the maximum specified thickness.

* 4.3.2 Seam and tubing side strength tests. Strength of the heat sealed seams and the folds at the side of the tubing shall be determined in accordance with Method B, ASTM D 882. The specimen shall be 1 inch in width and shall be cut from a finished bag with the seam or fold of the tubing across the short dimension and equidistant from the ends. The gage marks need not be applied and the elongation need not be measured. The initial separation between the grips of the apparatus shall be 2 inches and the specimen shall be placed in grips with the seam or fold of the tubing

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equidistant between the grips. The strength of the seams and folds of the side of the tubing, shall be the average of five determinations per sample unit for the seam, and five determinations per sample unit for the fold at the side of the tubing.

* 5. PACKAGING

* 5.1 Preservation. Preservation shall be level A or Commercial, as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A. Each bag shall be folded twice in half the length and then folded twice in half the width to measure approximately 23 by 9-1/2 inches. The instruction sheet specified in 3.4 shall be placed within the fold of each bag. Twenty folded bags shall be evenly stacked and then be completely wrapped with a sheet of 30-pound minimum basis weight kraft paper conforming to A-A-203. The paper wrap shall be secured with 2-inch minimum width gummed paper tape conforming to type III, grade B of PPP-T-45 or pressure-sensitive tape. Alternatively, the stacked mortuary bags shall be wrapped or bagged in a clear plastic film material. The plastic wrap or bag shall be secured with pressure-sensitive tape or by heat sealing.

* 5.1.2 Commercial. Each bag shall be preserved in accordance with ASTM D 3951.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or Commercial as specified (see 6.2).

* 5.2.1 Level A packing. Forty bags, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard shipping container conforming to style RSC-L, grade V2s of PPP-B-636. The inside of each shipping container shall be fitted with a box liner conforming to type CF, class weather-resistant, variety DW, grade V15c of PPP-B-636. Level A unit packs shall be packed flat, one in length, two in width, and one in depth within a shipping container. Inside dimensions of each shipping container shall approximate 23-1/2 inches in length, 19-1/2 inches in width, and 7-1/2 inches in depth. Approximate dimensions are furnished as a guide only. Each shipping container shall be closed in accordance with method III, waterproofed in accordance with method V, and reinforced as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636, except that the inspection shall be in accordance with 4.2.5. Shipping containers shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with MIL-L-35078 for the type and class of load specified (see 6.2). Strapping shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping, except for type II, class F loads.

* 5.2.2 Level B packing. Forty bags, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard shipping container conforming to style RSC-L, type CF (variety SW) or SF, class domestic, grade 275 of PPP-B-636. The inside of each shipping container shall be fitted with a box liner conforming to type CF, class domestic, variety DW, grade 275 of PPP-B-636.

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Level A unit packs shall be packed flat, one in length, two in width, and one in depth within a shipping container. Inside dimensions of each shipping container shall approximate 23-1/2 inches in length, 19-1/2 inches in width, and 7-1/2 inches in depth. Approximate dimensions are furnished as a guide only. Each shipping container shall be closed in accordance with method II as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636, except that the inspection shall be in accordance with 4.2.5.

* 5.2.2.1 Weather-resistant fiberboard containers. When specified (see 6.2), the fiberboard shipping container shall be a grade V3c, V3s, or V4s fiberboard box fabricated in accordance with PPP-B-636 and closed in accordance with method II as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636 except that the inspection shall be in accordance with 4.2.5.

* 5.2.3 Commercial packing. Bags, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in accordance with ASTM D 3951.

* 5.3 Palletization. When specified (see 6.2), bags, packed as specified in 5.2.2 and 5.2.3, shall be palletized on a four-way entry pallet in accordance with load type Ia of MIL-STD-147. Pallet type shall be type I (four-way entry), type IV or V in accordance with MIL-STD-147. Pallets shall be fabricated from wood groups I, II, III, or IV of MIL-STD-731. Each prepared load shall be bonded with primary and secondary straps in accordance with bonding means K and L or film bonding means O or P. Pallet pattern shall be in accordance with load pattern number 90 of the appendix of MIL-STD-147.

* 5.4 Marking. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or purchase order, unit packs, shipping containers, and palletized unit loads shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129 or ASTM D 3951, as applicable.

5.4.1 Plastic wrapped or bagged unit packs. Plastic wrapped or bagged unit packs shall have the required identification information legibly printed or stamped in black directly on the bag across the center face or on a white paper label inserted within the bag so as to permit ready identification.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The plastic mortuary bag is to be used as the liner component for the Pouch, Human Remains, MIL-P-10808, and as a separate item for containing human remains in mortuary operations.

* 6.2 Ordering data. Aquisition documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this document.
b. Selection of the applicable levels of preservation and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).
c. When weather-resistant grade fiberboard shipping containers are required for level B packing (see 5.2.2.1).
d. When palletization is required (see 5.3).
e. Type and class of unit load required (see 5.2.1).

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* 6.3 Changes from previous issue. The margins of this document have been marked with an asterisk (*) to indicate where changes (additions, modifications, corrections, deletions) from the previous issue were made. This was done as a convenience only and the Government assumes no liability whatsoever for any inaccuracies in these notations. Bidders and contractors are cautioned to evaluate the requirements of this document based on the entire content irrespective of the marginal notations and relationship to the last previous issue.

Custodians:

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Preparing activity:

Army - GL

Project No. 9930-0112

Review activity:

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
MIL-B-43861A	Bag, Plastic, Mortuary

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR
	☐ USER
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER *(Specify)*: _____

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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